

Class notes



Your Ultimate Pre-K–12 Education Guide

The **tri-base area** (RAF Lakenheath, RAF Mildenhall, and RAF Feltwell) offers excellent educational flexibility. Your first point of contact should always be the **School Liaison Program (SLO)**. Located in Building 950 on RAF Lakenheath, the SLO serves as your K–12 base education office. They advocate for military families, assist with credit transfers, and help navigate all local schooling systems.

You can reach the SLO team Monday through Friday from 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM via **DSN 226-5077/5078, Commercial 01638 52 5077**, or by emailing 48fss.ccl.slo@us.af.mil.

Be sure to check out the [RAF Lakenheath School Liaison Facebook Page](#) for real-time community updates.

On Base: DoDEA-Europe Schools

If you prefer an American curriculum, the Department of Defense Education Activity (**DoDEA**) operates five highly rated schools in the area.

School Breakdown by Grade

Because there are no schools located on RAF Mildenhall, students are distributed across Lakenheath and Feltwell based on age and housing location:

- **Lakenheath Elementary School (Pre-K–3):** Located on RAF Lakenheath.
- **Liberty Intermediate School (Grades 4–5):** Located on RAF Lakenheath.
- **Lakenheath High School (Grades 9–12):** Located on RAF Lakenheath.
- **Feltwell Elementary School (Pre-K–5):** Located on RAF Feltwell (11 miles from Lakenheath).
- **Lakenheath Middle School (Grades 6–8):** Located on RAF Feltwell.

Registration Requirements

DoDEA guarantees space for military dependents traveling on orders. There is no need to fully enroll before you arrive. Once you land, call your school's registrar to schedule an appointment.

To complete registration, you must present:

- PCS orders listing your dependents, or verification of employment.
- Passports or birth certificates.
 - Note that strict cut-off dates apply: children must be 4 for Pre-K, 5 for Kindergarten, and 6 for 1st Grade on or before September 1st.
- Hand-carry your child's immunization tracker, previous report cards, standardized test scores, and any Individual Education Plans (IEP).

Logistics: Buses and Meals

DoDEA school buses are operated by local commercial contractors.

Crucial Tip: Before signing a lease out in town, contact the Bus Office (DSN 324-846-7257 or Comm +44-1638-460257) to verify that your village sits within a designated DoDEA bus catchment area. Bus routes change annually, and driving in the UK can be a challenging adjustment. Families can also apply online for the Free or Reduced School Lunch Program once the school year starts.

Off- Base: The British School System

Enrolling your children in a local British school is an incredible way to immerse your family in UK culture. Most local schools are incredibly welcoming to American military families.

Key Structural Differences

- **Age Differences:** The UK system starts earlier. Children enter "Reception" classes at age 4.
- **The Calendar:** British schools operate on a year-round system. The summer break is shorter—roughly six weeks from mid-July to early September—interspersed with week-long "half-term" breaks in autumn, winter, and spring.
- **Staff Availability:** School staff are completely unavailable during the 6-week summer break, so start your research early.
- **Logistics:** School transportation is rarely provided by local councils; parents are generally responsible for the daily commute.

Performance Data & How to Apply

All British schools undergo strict government evaluations. You can read their official **Ofsted Inspection reports** online and evaluate local options using the [UK School Performance Tables](#).

Applications are managed by the local county council where you reside. The tri-base area sits at the intersection of three counties:

- [Suffolk County Council School Admissions](#)
- [Cambridgeshire County Council School Admissions](#)
- [Norfolk County Council School Admissions](#)

Early Education Grants

If you have a 3 or 4-year-old, you are eligible for **15 hours of free early education per week** through British nurseries, preschools, or licensed childminders. This grant remains active until your child reaches compulsory school age. To apply, visit your chosen nursery in person with your child, and the staff will submit the county paperwork on your behalf.

*Note: If your child has special educational needs, contact the School Liaison Office and the **Exceptional Family Member Program (EFMP)** coordinator before pursuing the British system to ensure necessary medical and insurance coverages align.*

Home Schooling in the UK

Home schooling is fully legal and widely supported for military families living in the United Kingdom.

The Best of Both Worlds

One of the unique benefits of home schooling while stationed at RAF Lakenheath is your access to DoDEA resources. Under command policies, home-schooled military dependents can:

- Enroll in **select classes** at DoDEA schools on a part-time basis.
- Participate in **extra-curricular activities**, sports, and auxiliary base services.

The School Liaison Office keeps a running network of local home-school support groups, co-ops, and resources. Reach out to them directly to get connected with the thriving local home-schooling community.